SE 216 – SOFTWARE PROJECT MANAGEMENT
Spring 2025-2026
Project Proposal

StorySphere: A Safe and Interactive Digital Platform for Writers and Readers

Problem Definition
Online story platforms ,such as Wattpad, let writers share their work and reach readers, but many have limitations. Content moderation and age verification are often unreliable, exposing users to inappropriate or +18 content. Writers have few tools to connect with readers, promote books, or showcase profiles, while readers struggle to find stories based on traits, professions, or themes. These issues lower the user experience, highlighting the need for a safer, more interactive, and feature-rich platform.

Background Information
Digital reading platforms have become increasingly popular as more readers prefer accessing stories online. Platforms where writers can publish their works provide opportunities for new authors to gain visibility and build a reader community. At the same time, readers benefit from accessing a wide variety of stories without cost. However, current platforms often focus mainly on publishing stories and offer limited social interaction features. Readers may want to communicate with other readers, join discussion groups, or interact directly with authors. Writers also need tools that allow them to present their identity, share updates, and promote their works effectively. In addition, content safety and moderation are important concerns in online platforms. Systems such as identity verification, content filtering, and age restrictions can help create a safer and more responsible digital environment. For these reasons, developing a platform that combines story publishing, social interaction, and content moderation can improve the overall experience for both writers and readers.

Objectives
•To develop a comprehensive and free digital platform that combines story publishing, social interaction, content safety, and advanced discovery features in a single system. Unlike current platforms, it offers unique features such as quote highlighting, quote bookmarking, and AI-supported story translation.

• To create verified author profiles, allowing writers to have personal pages, share posts, publish 24-hour stories, host live broadcasts, and add links to their printed or published books. Authors can also collaborate with other writers on stories and add interactive polls to their works—features rarely found on existing platforms.

• To implement robust safety and moderation mechanisms, including author identity verification, mandatory age verification for +18 content, most current platforms do not offer author identity verification, and automatic filtering of offensive language, slang, or explicit sexual content. These security measures are lacking on most existing platforms.

• To enhance reader and writer interaction, enabling story ratings, reviews, comments, messaging between readers, book club groups, and the unique “Blend” feature for reading stories together with friends—something not available on current platforms.

• To support multiple content formats, including traditional text stories, manga-style visual books, and audiobook versions. Unlike existing audiobook platforms, this system allows readers to interact, discuss, and experience stories together while listening.

• To provide advanced discovery and accessibility features, such as searching stories based on specific characteristics (e.g., main character name, profession, or story theme) and integrating AI-supported translation to make stories automatically available in multiple languages. Popular platforms do not currently offer this level of precise discovery or global accessibility.

Approval Signatures and GitHub Accounts

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